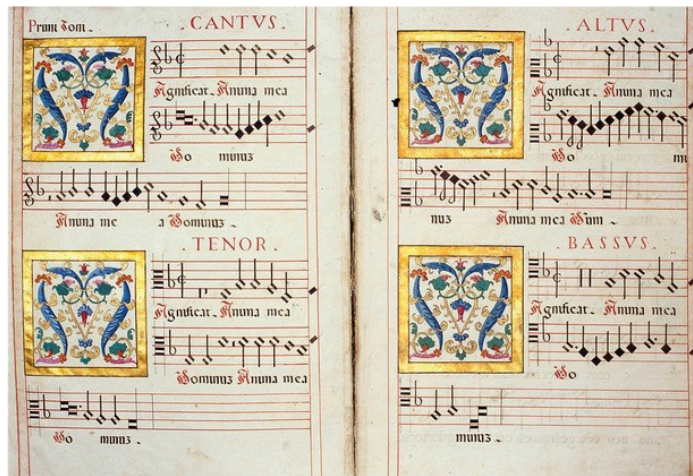




SCORE OF MAGNIFICAT

This illuminated 16th-century manuscript is the first double page of Palestrina's score of one of his settings for the Magnificat, or the hymn of praise by Mary, as found in the Bible.

Music from Heaven

Palestrina was famous in his lifetime and his reputation remained high through the succeeding centuries. His works were widely studied as perfect technical examples of polyphony and were admired by composers from Bach to Mendelssohn, who claimed that Palestrina's music sounded "as if it came direct from Heaven."